

Environmental Storytelling Design Document - *Ang Gagamba Ko*

Overview

Vale's villages, towns, and cities vary in levels of retro-future tech architecture in a magical realist setting. These styles of buildings and items are old mixed in with the new; a look into the past versus how they're moving forward. It takes inspiration from Frutiger Aero and later 90s to early 2000s stylings with old architecture in Southeast Asia.

NPC Interactions

When conversing with NPCs—whether eavesdropping or talking to them—they may drop hints to where to go or look forward with regard to the game's current happenings.

Finding Gagamba and Gagamba Related Shops

When searching for gagamba to catch and collect, the player can observe threads of silk scattered around the environment to indicate one is nearby. They can also use their knowledge of the real world to investigate places where gagamba may be located. Examples include, but are not limited to: bushes in parks, damp and dark areas, and bright sources of light at night.

Specific shops are dedicated to catching and safely housing gagamba in technologically advanced matchboxes. They also contain items that can be used in battle to aid your gagamba. These shops are indicated by a spider icon.

Magic Trees and Magic Tree Related Shops

The magic plant cultivars gagamba use in *laban ng gagamba* are a protected species. As a result, these magical trees found in the wild are either in areas explicitly closed off to the public or fenced off where people can view the trees in their natural habitat from a safe distance.

Specific shops are dedicated to growing, propagating, and selling these magic trees and cuts of branches for grafting. These shops are indicated by a branch icon.

Tournament Venues

Crowded areas full of fanfare. In terms of participating in the tournament, the organization in charge of the championship tournament is fairly organized. NPCs and signs are most helpful here at directing the player on where to go. Screens show past or ongoing *laban ng gagamba*, while posters or tables may be advertising and selling merchandise or *laban ng gagamba* related items.

Travelling Between Islands

In terms of vehicles, Vale further solidifies itself in the retro-future theme with vehicles from the 70s-80s in SEA, while public transportation is futuristic and uses rockets or hover technology.

These moments of travel serve as a breather between tournaments and story beats.

The goal of these moments is to leave the player with anticipation for what's ahead, a bittersweet but necessary farewell for what they just left behind, and a sense of awe and wonderment for the short-lived stretch of ocean in between.

Advertisements and Media

This can be told through posters on the street, or ones shown on screens of varying sizes. Posters, books, and shows can parody popular media, making them spider themed in some way.

Advertisements in a city can be posted on billboards or large screens. Inside buildings, ads would be seen on TV. In a school, most posters would advertise school events. Information on screens can also broadcast *laban ng gagamba*, advertisements for various products that the player can purchase in the game or news that further builds out the world.

Suburban Areas

Suburban areas lean towards more retro and rustic styles of buildings. They look and feel weathered. In these areas and buildings, more important paths will be indicated by being in better condition. Posters and graffiti, especially when on the off-beaten path, can help direct a player where to go when they have more freedom on where they can explore. Important buildings or locations can be indicated with an inviting entrance.

Urban Areas

Urban areas use more refined and polished materials, leaning towards the more futuristic side of retro-future. The streets are sleek and clean, with screens and NPCs guiding the player to their destinations.